

Sunday, 13 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light rain 22° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 23° 17°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 21° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Donald Trump has declared a united Ireland would be 'fantastic' during a visit to Dublin, sparking a diplomatic response from Downing Street.

The former US President made the comments during a meeting with Irish leader Micheál Martin. However, Downing Street quickly reiterated its commitment to the Good Friday Agreement.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Three people have been arrested at rival protests in Portsmouth, as new police powers came into force.

Demonstrators marched through the city, leading to arrests including a 76-year-old man suspected of concealing his identity. The incident highlights ongoing tensions surrounding public demonstrations.

PROTEST · UK
- 3

A major crackdown on e-bike crime has led to 187 arrests in London, with police using high-powered bikes to pursue suspects.

The Metropolitan Police released footage showing officers on Sur-Ron bikes in pursuit of individuals. This initiative aims to tackle the growing issue of crime involving e-bikes.

CRIME · UK
- 4

An inquest has heard how a mother died from aggressive cancer after a nine-month wait for test results.

Sarah Catherine Daniels did not receive potentially life-extending treatment quickly enough, according to the hearing. The case raises serious concerns about delays in medical diagnoses.

HEALTH · UK
- 5

The boss of AI company Anthropic is calling for a slowdown in artificial intelligence development, citing growing global concerns.

Dario Amodei's comments come amidst increasing worries that AI models could soon inflict serious damage worldwide. It's a significant statement from a major player in the tech industry.

TECHNOLOGY · GLOBAL

What's coming up

1 **Stacey Solomon and Alesha Dixon are set to take over as hosts of The Voice UK in a big ITV revamp of the show.**

The popular duo will replace Emma Willis, who has hosted the singing competition since 2014. It's a fresh new look for the upcoming series.

ON AIR – What do you make of the new presenting duo? A good choice for The Voice?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Dance music legends The Prodigy have been announced as the first headline act for Creamfields 2027.**

The iconic group will top the bill at the renowned dance music festival. Fans are already buzzing about their highly anticipated performance.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see The Prodigy headline Creamfields? Have you ever seen them live?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Oasis have teased a potential tour announcement with a spectacular drone display over Manchester's Etihad Stadium.**

The sky above the Joie Stadium, home to Manchester City Women, was lit up with the band's imagery. It's sent fans into a frenzy, hoping for a reunion tour.

ON AIR – Could this finally be it – an Oasis reunion tour? Are you hoping for tickets?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **Céline Dion has been delighting fans by duetting with them ahead of her much-anticipated comeback concert in Paris.**

The Canadian singer, who was diagnosed with an incurable condition four years ago, has been interacting with fans outside her hotel. Her return to the stage is eagerly awaited.

ON AIR – Isn't it lovely to hear Céline Dion is back engaging with fans and preparing for her return?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

5 **Leaked clips appearing to show the highly anticipated Grand Theft Auto 6 have surfaced online.**

While some might see it as a nightmare, others wonder if it'll actually hurt the biggest video game of the year. It's certainly got everyone talking about the upcoming release.

ON AIR – Have you seen the GTA 6 leaks? Does it make you more or less excited for the game?

GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **England have taken early control of the third and final Test against Pakistan, dominating on the opening day at Edgbaston.**

The home side closed the day on 156-4, establishing a 23-run lead after bowling Pakistan out for just 133. It's been a strong start for England as they push for a series whitewash.

ON AIR – What a dominant performance from England on day one! Can they maintain this momentum and seal the series?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Europe's Lottie Woad and the US's Nelly Korda delivered some of the best shots on day one of the 2026 Solheim Cup.**

The prestigious golf tournament has kicked off, showcasing top talent from both sides. It's shaping up to be a thrilling contest between Europe and the USA.

ON AIR – Are you following the Solheim Cup? Who are you backing, Europe or the USA?

GOLF · GLOBAL

3 **The San Francisco 49ers secured a big win in the first-ever NFL match held in Australia, beating the Los Angeles Rams.**

Quarterback Brock Purdy threw three touchdown passes in front of over 100,000 fans at the Melbourne Cricket Ground. It was a historic moment for American football down under.

ON AIR – Did you stay up to watch the NFL in Australia? What a spectacle!

NFL · GLOBAL

4 **Boxing figures are giving their predictions for Saturday's WBC welterweight world title fight between Ryan Garcia and Britain's Conor Benn.**

The highly anticipated showdown is set to take place, with both fighters comfortably making weight. It promises to be an explosive bout.

ON AIR – Who do you think will win the Garcia vs Benn fight? Are you rooting for Conor Benn?

BOXING · GLOBAL

5 **Cesc Fabregas has led Como into the Champions League, with many calling him Europe's next great coach.**

BBC Sport visited the club to discover the vision and philosophy of the former Arsenal and Chelsea star. His remarkable rise as a manager is certainly turning heads.

ON AIR – Who would have thought Cesc Fabregas would be such a successful manager? Could he manage in the Premier League one day?

FOOTBALL · EUROPE

Quick hits

- 1 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 2 A survey finds most of us have a drawer, shelf or cupboard we're slightly afraid to open.**
The 'everything drawer' is a near-universal feature of British homes. Inside: takeaway menus, dead batteries and one very important thing we'll never find again.
- 3 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 4 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 5 A study suggests we underestimate how much our neighbours would like to be asked for help.**
Researchers say a small favour often builds friendships faster than years of polite nodding over the fence.
- 6 The number of people learning to play an instrument as an adult is rising fast.**
Piano and guitar lead the way, with online lessons making it easier. The hardest part, learners say, is finding somewhere to practise without an audience.
- 7 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Two-thirds of us have pretended to like THIS to be polite.
ANSWER: A FRIEND'S QUESTIONABLE HOME COOKING.

Q The thing we most often put off until 'tomorrow' is THIS.
ANSWER: SORTING OUT THE PHOTOS ON OUR PHONE.

TALK TOPIC

- **Apparently the average household argues most about the thermostat.**
Who controls the heating in your house — and has it ever started a proper row?
- **A survey says most of us have a 'forbidden' word we can't stand.**
What's the word that makes your skin crawl? Go on, share it.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** Honey is one of the only foods that effectively never spoils. Sealed pots found in ancient tombs have reportedly still been edible thousands of years later.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A chippy in Lancashire now offers a 'loyalty' batter — regulars get their initials piped onto the fish in a special edible sauce.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Saturn would float if you could find a bathtub big enough — it's less dense than water.
- The average cloud weighs about the same as 100 elephants.
- Cats can't taste sweetness.
- The longest place name in Britain has 58 letters and is on Anglesey.
- Vending machines are statistically more dangerous than sharks.
- Humans are the only animals known to blush.
- A group of pugs is called a 'grumble'.
- The loudest natural sound ever recorded was the 1883 eruption of Krakatoa, heard thousands of miles away.

On this day

Day 256 of the year, 109 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Cross (Assyrian Church of the East); Christian feast day: Aimé (Amatus); Christian feast day: Amé (Amatus) of Remiremont; Christian feast day: John Chrysostom. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Isiah Whitlock Jr., American actor (died 2025)
- 1957 — Mal Donaghy, Northern Irish footballer and manager
- 1963 — Robin Smith, South African-English cricketer
- 1977 — Fiona Apple, American singer-songwriter, producer, and pianist
- 1952 — Randy Jones, American pop and disco singer
- 1939 — Richard Kiel, American actor and voice artist (died 2014)
- 1946 — Frank Marshall, American director and producer
- 1940 — Brian Brain, English cricketer (died 2023)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — Largest anti-Apartheid march in South Africa, led by Desmond Tutu.
- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is appointed General Secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1997 — A German Air Force Tupolev Tu-154 and a United States Air Force Lockheed C-141 Starlifter collide in mid-air near Namibia, killing 33.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1968 — Cold War: Albania leaves the Warsaw Pact.
- 1971 — Chairman Mao Zedong's second in command and successor Marshal Lin Biao flees China after the failure of an alleged coup. His plane crashes in Mongolia, killing all aboard.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1993 — Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin shakes hands with Palestine Liberation Organization chairman Yasser Arafat at the White House after signing the Oslo Accords granting limited Palestinian autonomy.
- 1948 — Deputy Prime Minister of India Vallabhbhai Patel orders the Army to move into Hyderabad to integrate it with the Indian Union.

- 1971 — State police and National Guardsmen storm New York's Attica Prison to quell a prison revolt, which claimed 43 lives.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 257 of the year, 108 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aelia Flaccilla (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Cormac mac Cuilennáin (or of Cashel); Christian feast day: Crescentius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Alex Clare, English singer and songwriter
- 1991 — Shayne Topp, American actor and Smosh cast member
- 1967 — John Power, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1996 — Hugh Bernard, English cricketer
- 1978 — Danielle Peck, American singer-songwriter
- 1987 — Tinchy Stryder, Ghanaian-English rapper and producer
- 1934 — Don Walser, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2006)
- 1986 — Steven Naismith, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1993 — Lufthansa Flight 2904, an Airbus A320, crashes into an embankment after overshooting the runway at Okęcie International Airport (now Warsaw Chopin Airport), killing two people.
- 2008 — Aeroflot Flight 821, a Boeing 737-500, crashes into a section of the Trans-Siberian Railway while on approach to Perm International Airport, in Perm, Russia, killing all 88 people on board.
- 1998 — Telecommunications companies MCI Communications and WorldCom complete their \$37 billion merger to form MCI WorldCom.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2002 — Total Linhas Aéreas Flight 5561 crashes near Paranapanema, Brazil, killing both pilots on board.
- 2007 — Prelude to the 2008 financial crisis: Northern Rock bank experiences the first bank run in the United Kingdom in 150 years.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar